



Java EE 6 simplifies development

Sun Microsystems has announced the availability of the Java Platform Enterprise Edition 6 (Java EE 6) and significant industry support from Java technology licensees including Caucho, IBM, Oracle and Red Hat. Java EE is touted as a premier platform for Web and enterprise application development and deployment. The new version introduces features to increase the flexibility of the platform and enable companies to use specific application scenarios, in addition to the full enterprise platform, to help meet different use case requirements.

The new specification introduces Profiles, which targets the platform at specific application scenarios. Profiles provides more flexibility for customers, ISVs and platform vendors and allows them to better address new and existing markets. It also defines extensibility features as a means to embrace and support external communities and innovations and allows them to cleanly 'plug in' to the platform. In addition, Java EE 6 specifies a process and a set of technologies that may be 'pruned' from future releases of the platform, allowing vendors and application providers to plan their migration to newer technologies that will be offered in upcoming versions of the platform. It is available as a free download at <http://java.sun.com/javaee/downloads/index.jsp>.



SugarCRM 5.5 offers custom mobile views

SugarCRM has announced the general availability of Sugar 5.5 which includes a new Web services framework, platform improvements, the ability to create custom themes, and enhanced mobile features. New application capabilities include features for managing SugarCRM in a mobile environment and the ability to assemble teams to collaborate on projects. The new release introduces new platform capabilities to integrate and present data within SugarCRM. These capabilities include: an enhanced Web services framework, a themes framework, and advanced password management. The Sugar Community Edition is available for download at www.sugarforge.org.



Petabyte-scale clustered storage in a few mouse clicks

Gluster, a leading provider of scalable open source storage solutions, has launched the Gluster Storage Platform. By integrating the GlusterFS file system with an OS layer and improved management user interface, Gluster provides a complete storage software platform that simplifies the task of deploying petabyte-scale storage to two installation steps and a few mouse clicks. The new platform addresses the complexity of managing 'big data,' the demanding scalability requirements of modern applications, and the accelerating growth of virtual server deployments. Key highlights include: the complete platform image fitting on a USB memory stick that can configure a bare server to a clustered storage node in 15 minutes or less; unified global namespace; Web-based installation and management; and high availability. For more information please visit www.gluster.com.



DRBD merged into Linux!

Linus Torvalds has merged the data replication solution Distributed Replicated Block Device (DRBD) into Linux as a fully-supported component. After exactly 10 years of ongoing development work—Phil Reisner wrote the first line of code on December 8, 1999—Torvalds' acknowledgement means DRBD has become a fixture on the storage market.

Reisner first published DRBD as part of his master's thesis. Originally intended as a means of storing e-mail messages in a redundant fashion, Reisner realised the full potential of the newly developed solution. In November 2001, he co-founded LINBIT, a Vienna-based enterprise focussed on advancing the development of DRBD and Linux high-availability. Linux 2.6.33, of which DRBD will be an integral part, is currently expected in February 2010.

Monta Vista acquired

Cavium Networks, a provider of highly integrated semiconductor products that enable intelligent processing for networking, wireless, storage and video applications, has announced that it has completed its acquisition of MontaVista Software, Inc., finalising an agreement that was announced on November 10, 2009.

MontaVista is one of the leaders in multi-core embedded Linux OS, virtualisation, development tools and professional services. This acquisition will complement Cavium Network's broad portfolio of multi-core processors to deliver more compelling, integrated and differentiated embedded solutions to the market, company sources reported.